Rivlin made a particular effort to combat the endemic anti-Arab racism in Israel. Like Netanyahu, he is a longtime supporter of Beitar Jerusalem, one of Israel's top football clubs. In early 2013, after the club signed two Muslim players from Chechnya, fans hoisted a banner that read "Beitar, forever pure". They chanted "no entry to Arabs", and called the club's owner a "whore". The Beitar coach, Eli Cohen, condemned the fans, but offered a bit of his own racism in response: the Chechens, he explained, were good European Muslims, and not the more sinister sort found "in the Middle East." Rivlin's response, delivered on International Holocaust Remembrance Day, was unequivocal. "Imagine the outcry if groups in England or Germany said that Jews could not play for them," he said.

"He really believes it. He's not just the 'tolerant' sort who goes to the Arab village occasionally for hummus," Tibi said. "He genuinely respects the Arab community." At a 2012 *iftar*, the meal that breaks the Ramadan fast, Rivlin described an effort to draft Israeli Arabs as "hypocrisy", even malice: "You don't have to be a genius to realize that it's impossible to draft the Arab public." A few months after his election, Rivlin became the first Israeli president to attend the annual memorial for the victims of the 1956 Kafr Qassem massacre, in which dozens of Israeli Arab civilians were gunned down by border police officers. "The Arab population in Israel is not a marginal group," he said. "We are destined to live side by side and we share the same fate."

Early in the 2014 school year, George Amire made a video about the bullying he received in school. The 11-year-old boy, a Christian from Jaffa, had been called "homo", "faggot", and other epithets by his classmates. He didn't speak in the video; instead he held up sheets of paper, first with the names he was called, then with a message to his bullies. "Don't judge people by how they look," said one. "Look at me, and then look at yourselves. We are the same." The video soon went viral, with hundreds of thousands of views on Facebook.

Rivlin quickly invited Amire to his office in Jerusalem, and they agreed to make a new video, sitting side-by-side on a couch, each holding up cards. Amire's bullying was not racist, but Rivlin connected it to the broader trends in society. "Violence, hostility, thuggery, racism, [these] are only a part of the bad things people encounter every day here in Israel, [and] that must not be in our state," their papers read. Perhaps the most powerful piece